A CLUE & CANDLE GAMES CASE FILE · START HERE

The Quillfeather Case File

A Cozy Printable Murder Mystery for 1–4 Players

60–90 MIN · AGES 12+ · PRINT & PLAY TONIGHT



18 evidence documents · **9** hint cards · offline answer checker · US Letter + A4

A bookseller has fallen from his library ladder, and a first edition is missing. Read the file, compare the papers and work out who did it. No acting and nothing gruesome: just you and the evidence.

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How to Play

1. **Print.** Use the checklist below. Black-and-white is fine. Print at 100% / "actual size."
2. **Read 01, the Case Briefing.** DI Moss's letter tells you what happened and sets your three objectives.
3. **Study the evidence.** Meet the suspects in 02, then work through the 18 documents in 03. Compare them: no single paper solves the case.
4. **Fill in 04 as you go.** Suspect matrix, Thursday timeline, and your written answers.
5. **Check each answer** with Case-Checker.html (offline, in any modern browser) or the sealed page of 97. Stuck? Take a hint card from 05, A before B before C.

Print checklist

#	FILE	PAGES	PRINT?
00	START HERE	3	Optional: fine on screen
01	Case Briefing	2	Print
02	Suspect Profiles	3	Print (cards can be cut)
03	Evidence Dossier, D1–D18	18	Print
04	Detective Worksheets	3	Print (one set per team)
05	Hint Cards	2	Print, cut and fold
06	Case Folder & Gift Labels	2	Optional
97	Objective Checks	3	Only if not using the checker
99	SOLUTION, read last	5	Fine on screen

Everything: 41 pages. Minimum to play (01–05): 28 pages. Both US Letter and A4 folders contain the same files with the same page counts.

> **BEFORE YOU START**
>
> Cut the hint cards without reading the hint halves, and fold them at once. If you use 97 instead of the checker, put each page in its own envelope (labels in 06) or fold it closed. Keep 97 and 99 out of sight until you need them.

Ways to Play

Two players (date night)

- Split the interviews (D4–D8) and read them aloud to each other.
- One of you keeps the timeline (04, sheet 2); the other keeps the suspect matrix.
- Agree before you open a hint card. Count how many hints you used.
- Lay the papers out on a big table. Spotting a match between two documents is half the fun.

Three or four players

- Deal the 18 documents out like cards. Each person reports what is in theirs.
- Give a younger detective (12+) a job: check claims against the floor plan (D1) or the bus timetable (D12).

Playing solo

- Read 01, then 02, then 03 in order, making notes in 04 as you go.
- Take a break after each objective. Fresh eyes catch more.
- Use the checker after each objective so you never run ahead on a wrong guess.

How long?

Most of the time goes on reading and comparing. Two players working together: about 60–90 minutes. One player: about 75–120 minutes.

What is in the file

01 briefing · 02 suspect cards · 03 evidence D1–D18 · 04 worksheets · 05 hint cards · 06 folder cover and labels · **97** one answer page per objective (open only after writing your answer) · **99** the full solution (open last) · **Case-Checker.html** type in your answers and it says only "Correct" or "Not quite – try a hint." It works offline; nothing is sent anywhere.

> **COZY AND FAIR**
>
> Rated PG for ages 12+. The death is described only as a fall from a ladder; nothing gruesome is shown or described. Every objective can be solved from the documents alone, by comparing at least two of them.

ABOUT THIS CASE

The Quillfeather Case File is an original story by Clue & Candle Games. It was written with AI assistance, and every clue was checked against the solution before release. All people, places and businesses in it are fictional. For personal and family use; please don't resell or share the files.